

Topic 3: Skill acquisition

Overview

Students are required to show an understanding of the nature and development of skills in sport. This understanding could be enhanced and developed through applied practical experiences in the role of either coach and/or performer. Students should have an awareness of the relevant learning theories and how they relate to skill development. At A Level, students will develop a detailed appreciation of the role of memory systems in the acquisition of skill.

Students are expected to be able to relate knowledge of practices, feedback and guidance to practical performance situations. Students should be able to understand how quantitative data can be generated in appropriate areas of skill acquisition and be able to produce and evaluate the meaning of such data.

Content

Subject content	What students need to learn
3.1 Coach and performer	3.1.1 Coaching styles to improve the performance of learners: command, reciprocal, guided discovery and problem solving.
	3.1.2 The development of tactics and strategies in a competition or performance to optimise outcome.
	3.1.3 Dissection of a skill in order to identify technical elements: preparation, execution and recovery phases leading to the correct result or outcome. Exploration of how to analyse a skill in order to identify any technical strengths and weaknesses. How to compare to higher-level performer.